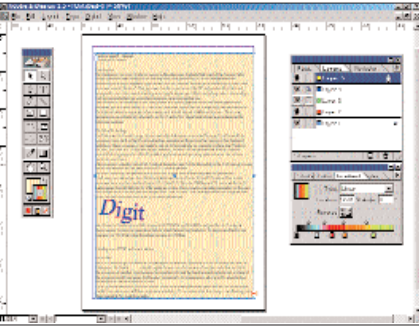


surprised. It can be done quite easily by drawing a path with the help of the pen or pencil tool (depends on what the software



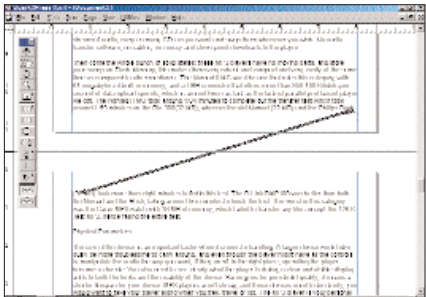
Layers and Gradient effects in InDesign

provides) and typing the text on to it as one would normally do. It is the software which does the trick by allowing text to

flow on a particularly drawn path. A page layout software should possess this important feature.

The new release of Adobe PageMaker tested here does not incorporate this feature. The developers at Adobe don't seem to be interested in developing this software, and are giving more importance to InDesign which does possess this feature. Unlike Publisher and Frame Maker, Quark and InDesign include this feature thereby giving the user the flexibility to type text on paths.

Gradient: It is a blend between two or more colours or tints of the same colour. Why would anybody want this element on a page layout software? This is primarily used by designers in generating two-tone effects in text and also in filling up drawn objects. One disadvantage here is that the colours are converted to CMYK mode



QuarkXPress provides on-screen display of linking of various pages

while printing, which raises the possibility of them appearing dull or shifted. Hence, most designers use this feature in CMYK mode.

InDesign, Quark and Publisher allow one to add gradients to objects but Publisher does not allow one to add it to text.

SCORE BOARD The Page Layout Software at a Glance

	Adobe Frame Maker +SGML 6.0	Adobe InDesign 1.5.2	Adobe PageMaker 7.0	Microsoft Publisher 2000	QuarkXPress 4.1
Company	Tricom International	Adobe Systems India Pvt Ltd	Adobe Systems India Pvt Ltd	Trifin Technologies	Quark India Pvt Ltd
Phone Numbers	022-8942461	0118-4532026	0118-4532026	011-6236061	0172-254412
Fax Numbers	022-8930504	0118-4532010	0118-4532010	011-6436447	0172-254414
E-mail Address	tricom@vsnl.com	sandeepm@adobe.com	sandeepm@adobe.com	trifin@vsnl.com	gprakash@quarkindia.com
Web site	www.tricommutimedia.com	www.adobe.com	www.adobe.com		www.quarkindia.com
Price (Rs)	90,000	42,946	26,500	4,500	34,000
Hard Disk Space	95 MB	50.6 MB	172 MB	60 MB	22 MB
Memory Usage	16.4 MB	22 MB	31.2 MB	7.6 MB	8.4 MB
Features					
Autoflow	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Text Editing Capabilities	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Creation of Tables	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	No
Various Colour Modes Supported	CMYK, RGB, HLS	CMYK, RGB, LAB	CMYK, RGB, HLS	CMYK, RGB	CMYK, RGB
Image Editing Capabilities	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Design Elements					
Paragraph Style Sheets	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
Character Style Sheets	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	Yes
Importing Images	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Column Guides	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Frames	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Layers	No	Yes	Yes	No	No
Masking	No	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
Text on Path	No	Yes	No	No	Yes
Gradient	No	Yes	No	Yes	Yes
Miscellaneous Features					
Dictionary	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Spell Check	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Wizards	No	No	No	Yes	No
Templates	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	No
Ratings	B-	A-	B	B	B+